

Postmortem

Success

- Using the asset packs from itch.io was a huge time saver that allowed us to focus entirely on the mechanics and the code rather than worry about making the game look good.
- We were able to successfully implement multiple unique upgrades per level by breaking up different mechanics we were working on into upgrades to be collected between levels. This allowed us to implement mechanics in a unique and interesting way.
- Implementing 3 different bosses all with their own unique mechanics and interesting tactics to beat them. We also were able to implement the bosses in order of difficulty, although that is subjective.

Failures

- Boss encounters were harder to build than expected because the game focuses on boss-only fights. Every boss needed unique mechanics, readable attacks, proper timing, damage handling, and smooth transitions. That made each encounter much more complex than a normal enemy.
- Lack of interesting upgrades because the upgrade system was supposed to be one of the main reasons for replayability, but the upgrades may have ended up feeling too simple or too similar. Many upgrades were basic stat boosts like more health, more damage, or faster movement. While these are useful, they do not always change how the player approaches combat in a meaningful way.
- A major failure was limited replayability, because after a few runs players would likely see the same bosses, upgrades, and strategies repeatedly, making the game feel predictable and reducing the excitement of replaying it.

“Two More Weeks” Improvements

- With two more weeks of development, we would add smaller enemies into boss fights to make encounters feel more dynamic and less repetitive, while also increasing replayability by giving bosses different enemy combinations and attack support.
- With two more weeks of development, we would improve the upgrade system by adding more unique and gameplay-changing upgrades, to make each run feel more different and rewarding.